

Week 1 Progress Report: A Manual Collection Methodology for the TruthLens AR Bangla Multimodal Misinformation Dataset

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Abstract: This report documents the data collection methodology adopted by the team during the first week of dataset construction for TruthLens AR. Rather than building an automated scraper at this early stage, the group chose a fully manual collection process so that each member could closely observe how Bangla misinformation is structured, written, and visually presented before any code is written. The report describes the folder organization, the file naming convention, the source list for both fake and authentic content, the step-by-step collection workflow used for every entry, and how the four-member team has divided the work going forward.

I. Week 1 Overview

We could have jumped straight into writing a scraper, but decided not to. Bangla misinformation rarely looks the same way twice one day it's a doctored photocard, the next a misleading TikTok clip, sometimes just a satirical post people mistake for real news. So this week was spent going through fact-check reports by hand, one at a time, to actually see those patterns before automating anything. It felt slow, but it should pay off once the OCR and VLM stages depend on this data being clean.

II. Folder Structure

We set up one shared Drive folder, TruthLens_Dataset, so all four of us work off the same copy instead of four scattered ones. Inside: images/ for screenshots, videos/ for clips, and a single dataset.xlsx that ties it all together by filename.

III. Where the Data Comes From

For fake and misleading content, Rumor Scanner is our main source, with Fact Watch, BOOM Bangladesh, and BD FactCheck filling the gaps these sites already verify the claim and explain why it's false, so we get ready-made ground truth for free. Real samples come separately from Prothom Alo, The Daily Star, and bdnews24, plus genuine government notices, so the dataset doesn't end up almost entirely fake the way early Bangla corpora like BanFakeNews did.

IV. Naming Convention and a Lesson Learned

Every file gets renamed the moment it's downloaded TL_img_XXX.jpg or TL_vid_XXX.mp4 instead of keeping whatever random name the phone or browser gives it. We also learned the hard way not to forward images through Messenger before saving them; it quietly compresses them, and a few early entries had to be re-downloaded straight from the source page because of this.

TABLE I

FULL SPREADSHEET SCHEMA (13 COLUMNS)

Column	What Goes In It
Data_ID	Unique ID, e.g. TL_VD_001
Claim_Text	The post text or headline, copied as-is
Image_File	Local image filename, or N/A
Video_File	Local video filename, or N/A
Evidence_File	Screenshot/clip of the fact-check proof itself
Label	Fake / Real / Misleading
FactCheck_URL	Link to the verification report
Explanation	1–2 lines on why it's fake (for VLM training)
Collection_Date	Date the entry was added to the sheet
Source_Platform	Facebook, TikTok, Instagram, YouTube, etc.
Confidence_Score	Annotator's confidence in the label, 1–5
Content_Type	Text_image / Text_video / Text_image_video
Category	Politics, Health, Science, Education, General, etc.

V. The Collection Workflow

Each entry follows the same five-step loop: open Rumor Scanner or Fact Watch and find a recent report; copy the original claim text and fact-check link directly (never paraphrased, to preserve authentic wording); download the image or video straight from the source page (not screenshots, to avoid compression loss) and rename it immediately following the TL_img/TL_vid convention before moving it into the right folder; write a short plain-Bangla explanation of how the fact-checkers proved the claim false, which becomes the ground truth for the VLM module; and finally add the row to the shared spreadsheet, double-checking it against the folder to confirm the filename exists.

VI. Team Division for the Coming Weeks

To hit roughly 1,000–1,500 multimodal entries by the end of month one, work is split by content type. Two members hunt fake/misleading news daily across the fact-check sites, aiming for about twenty entries each per day. One member collects authentic news cards and screenshots from mainstream outlets at a similar pace, keeping the real-vs-fake ratio balanced. The remaining member sources manipulated or deepfake video clips from YouTube Shorts and Facebook Reels, since video collection takes longer per item.

VII. What We Learned This Week

Reading through dozens of reports by hand gave us a real feel for how readable the Bangla text inside these screenshots actually is useful, since that directly affects how we'll configure OCR later. Once we hit 100–200 entries this way, the plan is to study the pattern closely enough to write a Python scraper (BeautifulSoup or Selenium) that follows the same schema for the rest.

VIII. Next Steps

Week 2 priorities: finish the first 100 manually collected entries, verify every referenced image/video file actually exists in the correct folder, and begin early scraper-design discussions for Rumor Scanner and Fact Watch.

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